# Study guide

## 工作　颜色　篮球　鸡蛋

gōngzuò　yánsè　lánqiú　jīdàn

Study a pattern, change one block, recall it, then write it.

73 expressions, 28 sentences. Seven groups from today’s classroom boards.

01　Meet someone

02　Where, then what

03　Work & everyday negation

04　Sports & reusable phrases

05　Colour families

06　Meat, eggs & powders

07　Recognise the building blocks

# Meet someone

Keep the question word where the answer belongs. 哪 nǎ asks “which”; 那 nà points to “that”; 这 zhè points to “this”. 你几岁？ is mainly for young children. 您贵庚？ is very formal and can sound old-fashioned; 你多大了？ is the ordinary classroom form. A polite wording does not make every personal question appropriate.

| | |
|---|---|
| 名字 | míngzi<br>name |
| 什么 | shénme<br>what |
| 姓 | xìng<br>surname; be surnamed |
| 贵姓 | guìxìng<br>your surname (polite) |
| 多大 | duō dà<br>how old; how big |
| 几岁 | jǐ suì<br>how old (usually children) |
| 贵庚 | guìgēng<br>your age (very formal) |
| 哪国人 | nǎ guó rén<br>from which country |
| 这 | zhè<br>this |
| 那 | nà<br>that |
| 哪 | nǎ<br>which |
| 哪里 | nǎlǐ<br>where |
| 哪儿 | nǎr<br>where (alternative) |

From the classroom board

## 你叫什么名字?

Nǐ jiào shénme míngzi?
What is your name?

# Meet someone

From the classroom board

## 你姓什么?

Nǐ xìng shénme?
What is your surname?

From the classroom board

## 您贵姓?

Nín guìxìng?
May I ask your surname?

From the classroom board

## 你多大了?

Nǐ duō dà le?
How old are you?

From the classroom board

## 你几岁?

Nǐ jǐ suì?
How old are you? (to a child)

From the classroom board

## 您贵庚?

Nín guìgēng?
May I ask your age? (very formal)

From the classroom board

## 你是哪国人?

Nǐ shì nǎ guó rén?
Which country are you from?

# Where, then what

Subject + 在 + place + action: 我在教室学习。 With no action, 在 can mean “be at”: 我在家。 哪里 and 哪儿 both ask “where”. Put 明天 or 昨天 before the subject or just after it. Contrast locating an activity with 在 directly before a verb, which can mark an action in progress.

| | |
|---|---|
| 家 | jiā<br>home; family |
| 超市 | chāoshì<br>supermarket |
| 教室 | jiàoshì<br>classroom |
| 宿舍 | sùshè<br>dormitory |
| 学校 | xuéxiào<br>school |
| 公司 | gōngsī<br>company |
| 咖啡店 | kāfēidiàn<br>café |
| 上海 | Shànghǎi<br>Shanghai |
| 苏州 | Sūzhōu<br>Suzhou |

From the classroom board

## 你在哪里?

Nǐ zài nǎlǐ?
Where are you?

From the classroom board

## 你在哪儿?

Nǐ zài nǎr?
Where are you? (alternative)

From the classroom board

## 我在家。

Wǒ zài jiā.
I am at home.

# Where, then what

From the classroom board

## 你在哪里工作?

Nǐ zài nǎlǐ gōngzuò?
Where do you work?

From the classroom board

## 我在学校工作。

Wǒ zài xuéxiào gōngzuò.
I work at a school.

From the classroom board

## 你的公司在哪儿?

Nǐ de gōngsī zài nǎr?
Where is your company?

From the classroom board

## 在上海。

Zài Shànghǎi.
In Shanghai.

From the classroom board

## 明天我在苏州工作。

Míngtiān wǒ zài Sūzhōu gōngzuò.
Tomorrow I will work in Suzhou.

From the classroom board

## 我在教室学习。

Wǒ zài jiàoshì xuéxí.
I study in the classroom.

From the classroom board

## 我在咖啡店看书。

Wǒ zài kāfēidiàn kàn shū.
I read in a café.

# Work & everyday negation

你工作吗？ asks whether someone works. 你做什么工作？ asks what job they do. 我不工作 describes the usual situation; 昨天我没工作 says the action did not happen yesterday. This is a useful contrast, not a rule that every past sentence uses 没 or every future sentence uses 不. 做作业 means “do homework”; 工作 can itself be a verb.

| | |
|---|---|
| 工作 | gōngzuò<br>work; job |
| 做作业 | zuò zuòyè<br>do homework |
| 学生 | xuésheng<br>student |
| 老板 | lǎobǎn<br>boss; business owner |
| 工人 | gōngrén<br>worker |
| 老师 | lǎoshī<br>teacher |
| 医生 | yīshēng<br>doctor |
| 大夫 | dàifu<br>doctor (another common word) |
| 律师 | lǜshī<br>lawyer |
| 律师事务所 | lǜshī shìwùsuǒ<br>law firm |
| 学习 | xuéxí<br>study; learn |
| 看书 | kàn shū<br>read a book |

From the classroom board

## 你做作业吗?

Nǐ zuò zuòyè ma?
Do you do homework?

# Work & everyday negation

From the classroom board

## 你工作吗?

Nǐ gōngzuò ma?
Do you work?

From the classroom board

## 我不工作。我是学生。

Wǒ bù gōngzuò. Wǒ shì xuésheng.
I do not work. I am a student.

From the classroom board

## 你做什么工作?

Nǐ zuò shénme gōngzuò?
What do you do for work?

From the classroom board

## 我是公司老板。

Wǒ shì gōngsī lǎobǎn.
I am a company owner.

From the classroom board

## 昨天我没工作。

Zuótiān wǒ méi gōngzuò.
I did not work yesterday.

# Sports & reusable phrases

Keep 打 + ball sport together: 打篮球, 打网球, 打乒乓球. Build 我喜欢 + activity. Do not add 打 to every sport. In 篮球, 篮 means “basket”; 蓝 means “blue”. The shared 监 is a sound clue in these two characters, while 竹 and ⺮ distinguish their written forms.

| | |
|---|---|
| 喜欢 | xǐhuan<br>like |
| 运动 | yùndòng<br>sport; exercise |
| 打篮球 | dǎ lánqiú<br>play basketball |
| 打网球 | dǎ wǎngqiú<br>play tennis |
| 打乒乓球 | dǎ pīngpāngqiú<br>play table tennis |

From the classroom board

## 你喜欢什么运动?

Nǐ xǐhuan shénme yùndòng?
What sports do you like?

Additional practice example

## 我喜欢打篮球。

Wǒ xǐhuan dǎ lánqiú.
I like playing basketball.

# Colour families

Colour + 色 makes a reusable colour noun: 红色, 蓝色, 粉色. 色 is not required in every colour expression. 青 covers a context-dependent blue/green range, not one fixed modern colour swatch. 粉色 is pink, but 粉 in 面粉 or 奶粉 means powder: the whole word decides the meaning.

| | |
|---|---|
| 颜色 | yánsè<br>colour |
| 彩虹 | cǎihóng<br>rainbow |
| 红色 | hóngsè<br>red |
| 橙色 | chéngsè<br>orange |
| 黄色 | huángsè<br>yellow |
| 绿色 | lǜsè<br>green |
| 青色 | qīngsè<br>blue-green; cyan (context matters) |
| 蓝色 | lánsè<br>blue |
| 紫色 | zǐsè<br>purple |
| 黑色 | hēisè<br>black |
| 白色 | báisè<br>white |
| 粉色 | fěnsè<br>pink |

Additional practice example

我喜欢蓝色。

Wǒ xǐhuan lánsè.
I like blue.

# Meat, eggs & powders

Animal + 肉 makes a meat word: 牛肉, 羊肉, 猪肉, 鸭肉. 鸡蛋 is an egg; 鸡肉 is chicken meat. 面粉, 奶粉 and 蛋白粉 share 粉, but name different products. Practise complete words, then change one meaningful block.

| | |
|---|---|
| 鸡蛋 | jīdàn<br>egg |
| 鸡肉 | jīròu<br>chicken meat |
| 牛肉 | niúròu<br>beef |
| 羊肉 | yángròu<br>mutton; lamb |
| 猪肉 | zhūròu<br>pork |
| 鸭肉 | yāròu<br>duck meat |
| 面粉 | miànfěn<br>flour |
| 奶粉 | nǎifěn<br>milk powder |
| 蛋白粉 | dànbáifěn<br>protein powder |

Additional practice example

我喜欢吃牛肉。

Wǒ xǐhuan chī niúròu.
I like eating beef.

# Recognise the building blocks

亻 is conventionally called 单人旁; 彳 is called 双人旁, but it is not historically “two people”. It relates to steps/walking. 手 often takes the side form 扌; 竹 often appears above as ⺮; 氵 is the water-side form. Components can give meaning or sound clues, not guaranteed definitions. 没 contains 氵, yet its everyday negative meaning is not “water”. 越来越 + adjective describes increasing degree: 越来越好.

| | |
|---|---|
| 江 | jiāng<br>river |
| 河 | hé<br>river |
| 湖 | hú<br>lake |
| 海 | hǎi<br>sea |
| 手 | shǒu<br>hand |
| 竹 | zhú<br>bamboo |
| 笔 | bǐ<br>pen; writing brush |
| 篮 | lán<br>basket |
| 行 | xíng<br>go; be OK (this reading) |
| 走 | zǒu<br>walk; leave |
| 超 | chāo<br>exceed; surpass |
| 越 | yuè<br>exceed; cross |
| 越来越 | yuè lái yuè<br>more and more |

Additional practice example

我的汉语越来越好。

Wǒ de Hànyǔ yuè lái yuè hǎo.
My Chinese is getting better and better.

# Compare before memorising

这 zhè
this

那 nà
that

哪 nǎ
which

篮 lán
basket

蓝色 lánsè
blue

鸡蛋 jīdàn
egg

鸡肉 jīròu
chicken meat

粉色 fěnsè
pink

面粉 miànfěn
flour

奶粉 nǎifěn
milk powder

我不工作。我是学生。 Wǒ bù gōngzuò. Wǒ shì xuésheng.
I do not work. I am a student.

昨天我没工作。 Zuótiān wǒ méi gōngzuò.
I did not work yesterday.

# Short reading check - without pinyin

Try saying the meaning and reading aloud. Cover the answer key until finished.

1. 你叫什么名字?
2. 你是哪国人?
3. 你做什么工作?
4. 我在学校工作。
5. 我在咖啡店看书。
6. 昨天我没工作。
7. 你喜欢什么运动?
8. 我喜欢蓝色。
9. 我喜欢吃牛肉。
10. 我的汉语越来越好。

# Answer key - check after trying

1. 你叫什么名字?

Nǐ jiào shénme míngzi?
What is your name?

2. 你是哪国人?

Nǐ shì nǎ guó rén?
Which country are you from?

3. 你做什么工作?

Nǐ zuò shénme gōngzuò?
What do you do for work?

4. 我在学校工作。

Wǒ zài xuéxiào gōngzuò.
I work at a school.

5. 我在咖啡店看书。

Wǒ zài kāfēidiàn kàn shū.
I read in a café.

6. 昨天我没工作。

Zuótiān wǒ méi gōngzuò.
I did not work yesterday.

7. 你喜欢什么运动?

Nǐ xǐhuan shénme yùndòng?
What sports do you like?

8. 我喜欢蓝色。

Wǒ xǐhuan lánsè.
I like blue.

9. 我喜欢吃牛肉。

Wǒ xǐhuan chī niúròu.
I like eating beef.

10. 我的汉语越来越好。

Wǒ de Hànyǔ yuè lái yuè hǎo.
My Chinese is getting better and better.